SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

AN ASSESSMENT OF COMPLIANCE TO THE REVISED MARKET CODE OF THE MUNICIPALITY OF NASIPIT

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Business and Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

By

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Statement of the problem- (quantitative)
Objectives of the study (qualitative)

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
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CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"An Assessment of Compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit"** presented and submitted by **Keren Happuch G. Hermosada, Rhea Mae B. Bandolon, Zeus John O. Danuco, Rowean S. Gabas, Ojay J. Lauro, Emelie R. Matilos, Antonette V. Rosales, Octchen M. Talibong.** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Public Administration** is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

TITLE:	An Assessment Of Compliance To The Revised Market Code Of The Municipality Of Nasipit
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III. FINDINGS

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IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

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Methodology
- **Provide the specific method that was used in your paper and the important details such as how did you do it.**

Findings
- **Highlight the significant findings of your paper.**

Recommendation
- **Just highlight the primary recommendation**

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DEDICATION

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Structure of a Dedication
1.**Opening Statement**
•Example: *"This thesis is dedicated to...*
2. **List and Explanation**
•Example: *"To my parents, for their love and support, and to my advisor, Dr. [Name], for invaluable guidance."*
3.**Closing (Optional)**
•Example: *"This work would not have been possible without you."*

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

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Suggested Structure

Opening Statement
• Express general gratitude for the opportunity to complete the research or thesis.

Acknowledgment of Advisors and Professors
• Thank your thesis advisor, committee members, or professors for their guidance and expertise.

Acknowledgment of Family and Friends
•Thank those who provided emotional or financial support.

Acknowledgment of Institutional or Financial Support
•Recognize scholarships, grants, or organizations that funded or facilitated your research.

Special Thanks (Optional)
Mention individuals who provided significant help, such as peers, mentors, or technical staff.

Closing Statement
•Conclude with a general expression of gratitude.

Example

I am deeply grateful to everyone who contributed to the completion of this thesis. My sincerest thanks to my advisor, Dr. [Name], for your invaluable insights and guidance. To my committee members, thank you for your constructive feedback and support.

To my family, your love and encouragement kept me going through this journey, and to my friends, your support meant the world to me. I would also like to thank [Institution/Organization] for funding this research.

Special thanks to [Name], for your assistance in [specific task]. To everyone who helped in any way, thank you for making this possible.

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

A public market is a vital component of local business and community life. People can exchange commodities, services, and cultural connections there. As a vibrant hub for people to congregate and a significant influence on nearby companies, it forms an integral part of many people's daily lives (Almonte et al., 2024). According to Zhong et al (2020), it is also crucial for local economic growth as it facilitates the establishment of small enterprises. According to Bonete et al. (2024), the public Market facilitates fair trade and food distribution in an environment that fosters community and a sense of belonging. The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (2024) asserts that local and traditional food shops are crucial in supporting small-scale farmers and ensuring access to healthy and fresh meals for individuals. It also mentioned that it is particularly true in nations where earnings fall below the middle class. They are essential links between sellers and buyers, and their presence enables small businesses to enter these markets more easily. A functioning market also has the potential to generate additional revenue for local governments (Wibisono et al., 2023).

International studies, on the other hand, point out problems such as the deplorable state of toilets in Lusaka district markets. Most of the markets in Zambia did not meet the country's requirements for cleanliness, privacy, and the condition and availability of amenities such as toilets and handwashing areas (Meki et al., 2021). A study in Kenya, East Africa, reported that people regarded the water and sanitation services as inadequate. Those present were either inaccessible or poorly maintained. There were also reports that market facilities, such as display stands and platforms, were absent. The allocated space for merchants to conduct their business was unsatisfactory in terms of the available area (Kuboka et al., 2024). Davies et al. (2022) state

that shops that are not well-planned or suitably located can be exposed to competition from other shops, resulting in fewer people wanting to shop there. They also stated that poor infrastructure and a lack of cleaning services can result in health and safety hazards. Moreover, many failures also occur because markets are constrained by infrastructure, equipment, and standards, such as a lack of benefits that promote sustainability, nutrition, or inclusion, high levels of market concentration, and weak value chain integration (Berdegue et al., 2023). Zeynudin et al. (2024) also demonstrated that fruits and vegetables sold in open-air markets in Ethiopia were often contaminated. Wardhana et al. (2021) also found that poor cleaning practices were a factor contributing to Indonesian chicken meat becoming infected with bacteria. Kosoko & Hassan (2021) further noted that some African markets lack sufficient numbers of toilets or clean facilities, which increases the spread of disease. Parkar et al. (2021) also emphasized the importance of maintaining market cleanliness by promoting environmental awareness and proper waste disposal.

From a local perspective, Tomas (2022) further explained that the Omnibus Market Code in Tarlac City implements vendor activities, maintains order and cleanliness, and promotes discipline. The study indeed highlighted the fact that conditions outside the wet Market significantly impact its operations, with most vendors offering a diverse array of goods and services. Carmen et al. (2020) also argued that markets are crucial, as they bring producers into contact with customers, thereby providing small businesses with better opportunities to enter the Market. Similarly, Basadre et al. (2025) found that fish vendors in Panabo Public Market also neglect good hygiene practices, and there are key control points where contamination could occur. Moreover, diseases like cholera, dysentery, typhoid, intestinal worm infections, and polio have been an issue due to poor sanitation. This exacerbates malnutrition adds to the growing problem of antibiotic resistance. In Northern Mindanao, according to Araune et al (2024),

compliance with sanitation regulations at the barangay level remains problematic due to inadequate awareness and weak enforcement. Furthermore, stall owners raise concerns about maintenance and sanitation (Alvarez & Mananap, 2024). Atilano-Tang and Laudin (2023) have also found that the ban on non- biodegradable plastic bags imposed by Zamboanga City has minimized plastic trash and improved the city's cleanliness, despite inadequate law enforcement resources. Similarly, Baptista et al. (2024) found that when authorities clearly implemented rules and sanctions, people in the Cabugao Public Market were more likely to follow regulations on single-use plastics and Styrofoam.

Recognizing that many public markets fail to fully implement existing ordinances, this study evaluates how well vendors, customers, and market officials in the Nasipit Public Market comply with the Revised Market Code, highlighting non-compliance and overall adherence. Anchored in the Local Government Code (LGC) of 1991, which empowers municipalities to regulate market activities, the Revised Market Code of Nasipit (Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020) specifies local duties, and assessing compliance delivers evidence-based recommendations for more efficient, safe, and orderly market operations.

This study helps the Municipal Mayor by providing data to identify enforcement gaps, improve administration, and guide policy decision. For the Sangguniang Bayan in strengthening the implementation of the Revised Market Code and improving market operations. For vendors, this study will help them by clarifying their rights and responsibilities and promoting better compliance. For consumers by contributing to a safer and more convenient market experiences. For local market authorities in understanding and fulfilling their enforcement duties. Ultimately, College of Business and Management, it will provide a real-world insight into how regulations and managerial decisions influence market operations and sustainability.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This chapter reviews related studies on the research variables. It discusses the independent variables, including the respondent's demographic profile (respondent's profile according to their role in the market namely; vendors, consumer, and local market authorities) and the dependent variables such as sanitation, security and safety, service area/facilities, occupancy of stalls, rules of conduct, restrictions, prohibition, market fees and charges, electrical charges/fees, general provision and control, and market personnel. It also identifies deficiencies and explains which areas of the provisions are most and least adhered to.

Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020, or the "Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit," is a comprehensive law that regulates the entire operation of the Nasipit Public Market. Its main purpose is to ensure that the market is clean, safe, orderly, and properly managed for both vendors and consumers. The ordinance defines key terms, organizes market sections, and sets standards for sanitation, waste disposal, drainage, and public health. It also outlines clear procedures for applying for and occupying market stalls, including requirements, rental fees, limitations, and grounds for cancellation. These rules promote fairness and prevent misuse of market spaces. Additionally, the ordinance lists prohibited acts, such as unauthorized peddling, selling intoxicating drinks, storing hazardous materials, and improper use of stalls, to maintain safety and discipline within the market. The ordinance further provides a detailed schedule of market fees and electrical charges, ensuring transparency in revenue collection that supports market maintenance. It also specifies the duties of the Market Administrator, Treasurer, and other officials responsible for implementing and enforcing the rules.

Vendor

People who sell things at public markets are part of the informal economy, according to Derla and Balongoy (2023). Local, self-employed business owners offer a wide range of goods and services to the community, including meat, vegetables, raw materials, local crafts, and other essential items that people need. However, these providers are crucial for creating jobs and maintaining economic stability, despite often being overlooked. It demonstrates the importance of supporting local companies and providing community members with affordable goods.

According to Lano et al. (2025), every customer's preference in the Calapan City Public Market is quite dependent on the performance of the vendors and overall market service delivery. The responsive service, price equity, and availability of products have brought a high level of customer satisfaction and competitiveness in the marketplace. The research by Atilano-Tang & Laudin (2023) demonstrated that banning single-use plastic, particularly plastic bags, was highly effective due to the considerable compliance of vendors and consumers in bringing their own reusable bags, which ultimately reduced plastic bag usage in practice. Similarly, during on-site surveys, vendors have demonstrated considerable awareness and compliance with regulations, ensuring public health and safety, as well as environmental protection.

However, it is essential to remember that vendors and public markets still face numerous challenges that require assistance and solutions, despite these changes and their significant roles in society. Some sellers reported that customers complained that the other types of packaging did not last as long and cost more than plastic bags. As a result of new rules and the need to make a living for themselves and others, vendors may struggle to cope with such economic and practical issues (Baptista et al., 2024). Sarfo et al. (2025) further highlight that the potential of street food vendors is limited by challenges related to inadequate packaging, storage, preparation, and handling practices, which are frequently unhygienic and reflect low compliance with

recommended food safety standards, thereby posing health risks to consumers.

Consumer

The customer, also known as a citizen, is one of the most critical individuals in a public market. Not only that, but they also power the market economy. In public markets, people buy and sell goods and services. Customer wants, needs, and buying habits have a significant impact on how the Market works and how long it will last (Lano et al., 2025). According to Alvarez and Mananap (2024), their ability to buy things has a direct effect on how much money sellers make and on the overall economy of the Market. Attracting a large number of people and generating regular sales can help vendors sustain their businesses. In this regard, it helps local companies to grow. Customers who are satisfied with the Market are likely to return and recommend it to others. By doing this, it builds a group of loyal customers that helps the Market maintain its good name and generate revenue (Tumbagahan et al., 2021). Satisfied customers of the Market are likely to return and recommend it to others. In so doing, it develops a loyal customer base that contributes to maintaining a good reputation and generating income for the Market (Tumbagahan et al.,2021). Dudziak et al. (2023) also state that in public markets, the choices regarding the range of products displayed by sellers and the purchasing frequency of consumers are.

In this regard, Tacardon et al. (2023) indicated that consumers in Manila paid close attention to the perceived quality and affordability of street food when choosing what to purchase. It follows that consumers in both the unofficial and official markets demonstrate a preference for quality and are willing to pay more for such high-quality products. What people want influences the types of things or services in the Market. Vendors in the Market modify the products they sell, including fruits, vegetables, ready-to-eat foods, and handcrafts, to meet the diverse needs and preferences of their clientele (Lano et al., 2025).

However, customers are vital to the success of public markets, and they can also contribute to the aggravation of cleanliness and sanitation problems. Poor waste disposal, a lack of concern for food items, and unhygienic conditions make the conditions unpleasant for both the seller and buyer (Kosoko et al., 2021). According to Wallace et al. (2022), consumers who lack sufficient knowledge about food safety are more likely to purchase unsafe or contaminated goods. The situation not only endangers people's health but also damages the credibility of the public Market, driving customers away from it

Moreover, Buhion et al. (2024) stated that the way people purchase things highly affects the amount of trash produced in the Market. Single-use plastics, excessive packaging, and food waste increase the volume of trash people must handle each day. As Lano et al. (2025) noted, changes may introduce new challenges for vendors. Often, the drive for cheaper, better, and easier-to-use goods forces vendors to change their pricing strategy and the way they stock goods. Similarly, according to Tendero (2023), the people's desire for perfectly shaped fruits and vegetables led them to contribute to food loss, as sellers disposed of foods that were still edible but not aesthetically appealing. This behavior not only incurs financial costs for the seller but also raises environmental concerns. Likewise, Pitriyanti and Kartika (2024) mentioned that traditional markets still have poor cleanliness, with trash piling up and limited areas for cleaning.

Additionally, the Conner Public Market faced issues, problems, and concerns, particularly when there were no established rules, insufficient funding, and stands that were too close to each other (Cabilatazan, 2021). According to Ni'am et al. (2024), illegal customer behavior can make the Market less safe and less organized. Haggling excessively, breaking items, or making excessive noise can harm sellers' businesses and negatively impact customers' experiences. The worst things that can happen are theft and damage, which hurt sellers' profits and make the market community feel unsafe. These actions demonstrate that customers are crucial to the Market's success.

However, bad behavior from them can compromise fairness, safety, and the long-term well- being of the entire public market system.

Local Market Authorities/ Market Personnel

The Revised Market Code of Nasipit clearly mandates the designation of a Market Administrator or Supervisor to oversee the operations of the public market. This official is responsible for supervising all market personnel, particularly those tasked with ensuring safety, cleanliness, and peace and order within the market premises. Appointed and supervised by the Municipal Mayor, the Market Administrator or Supervisor is expected to strictly comply with the provisions of the Code as well as other relevant laws, rules, and regulations (Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020). This legal framework underscores the importance of strong administrative leadership in sustaining orderly and efficient market operations.

Building on this legal foundation, effective market management is widely recognized as a key factor in maintaining order, increasing local revenue, and improving service delivery at the municipal level. Studies emphasize that market leadership often emerges from within the vendor community, which promotes mutual understanding and cooperation among stakeholders. Market leaders play a crucial role in disseminating information through various channels such as loudspeakers, committees, notice boards, and digital platforms like WhatsApp, ensuring that vendors and consumers remain informed and engaged. According to Ninsiima et al. (2025), this participatory and communicative approach strengthens economic activity, fosters social cohesion, and supports sustainability through programs that promote sanitation, aesthetic maintenance, and basic financial management.

In addition to leadership and communication, the presence of competent market personnel is essential in maintaining cleanliness and order. Ni'am et al. (2024) highlight that visible and active market officials contribute significantly to improving the quality of life of market users

by ensuring orderly and sanitary conditions. From a broader governance perspective, effective public market management reflects the capacity of local governments to balance social and environmental concerns. Economically, strategies such as adjusting rental fees for stalls and kiosks help minimize vendor expenses while sustaining stable market revenues. These approaches enable local governments to pursue economic growth without compromising inclusivity (Adhayanto & Arianto, 2021).

Further emphasizing the role of local government, Tomas (2022) discussed how market authorities regulate and organize public markets through the establishment and enforcement of rules governing stalls, facilities, and shared spaces. His study revealed that proper regulation helps ensure fairness and efficiency, while openness to non-traditional businesses and franchises can diversify market activities and encourage entrepreneurship. However, the same study also exposed persistent governance issues in the Tarlac Public Market, such as the misuse of stalls, unauthorized occupancy, and widespread violations of the prohibition on subletting. These problems are exacerbated by insufficient supervision, inadequate sanitation, and improper waste disposal, despite the existence of clear regulations.

Moreover, the study identified deeper governance challenges, including limited stakeholder participation, weak communication, and ineffective engagement mechanisms. Leadership–vendor interactions were largely one-sided, with instructions imposed without meaningful dialogue. Opportunities for collaboration, such as meetings and workshops, were rarely utilized, limiting collective problem-solving. Vendors also received minimal support in skills development, as most training initiatives were conducted by external organizations rather than market authorities. This lack of capacity-building, coupled with restricted access to learning resources and insufficient training on food handling and hygiene, further hindered vendor growth (Ninsiima et al., 2021).

Consistent with these findings, a Zamboanga-based study identified limited resources as a major challenge in policy implementation, particularly in enforcing regulations and monitoring compliance. Low budget allocation and inadequate manpower were found to weaken the effectiveness of market governance (Atilano-Tang & Laudin, 2023). Supporting this observation, Pitriyanti and Kartika (2024) concluded that market management remains largely inadequate, highlighting the persistent need for improved administrative capacity, resource allocation, and inclusive governance in public market operations.

Sanitation

Sanitation is a fundamental component of public health because it helps create environments that support healthy and productive living. In public markets, proper sanitation is especially important due to frequent human interaction and food handling. However, several studies show that sanitation standards in many markets remain inadequate. For instance, Frebriani et al. (2025) reported that temporary waste disposal areas do not meet health standards and that drainage systems are poorly maintained. As a result, market environments become unhealthy, negatively affecting consumer experience and increasing the risk of disease transmission. These conditions suggest that basic sanitation is not being properly managed by responsible authorities.

Moreover, international health organizations emphasize the importance of sanitation in preventing disease and promoting overall well-being. The World Health Organization (2024) stated that sanitation issues affect not only individual health but also environmental balance and daily human activities. Poor hygiene can lead to various communicable diseases such as diarrhea, typhoid fever, cholera, dysentery, intestinal worm infections, and malnutrition. In response, the World Health Organization (2023) releasssssssed guidelines aimed at improving sanitation in markets.

These guidelines highlight essential practices such as keeping environments clean and avoiding contamination to protect public health and ensure food safety.

In addition, several empirical studies have demonstrated the direct relationship between poor sanitation and food contamination in public markets. Wardhana et al. (2021) found high levels of bacterial contamination in chicken meat sold in local markets in Surabaya, Indonesia, including Staphylococcus aureus, Salmonella spp., and Escherichia coli. According to the researchers, these findings were largely due to poor sanitation and hygiene practices during slaughtering, handling, and marketing. This study emphasizes the importance of maintaining proper sanitation throughout the food supply chain to prevent foodborne illnesses.

Similarly, Zeynudin et al. (2024) reported high levels of contamination in fresh fruits and vegetables sold in open-air markets in Ethiopia. The contamination was attributed to inadequate washing and unhygienic handling practices. These findings further strengthen the link between sanitation practices and food safety. However, despite the recognized importance of sanitation, many developing countries continue to face serious waste management challenges. Akpoghira (2020) noted that the increasing accumulation of waste in urban market centers has become a major environmental and public health concern.

Furthermore, improper solid waste management contributes significantly to poor sanitation in public markets. Umerie et al. (2022) observed that self-littering is a common practice in Nigeria, where unsegregated waste is often disposed of in open dumping sites. This practice poses risks to both human health and the environment. Proper solid waste management includes waste generation control, storage, collection, transportation, segregation, processing, and disposal. Parkar et al. (2021) emphasized that waste segregation at the source, using color-coded bins, helps reduce landfill waste and supports environmentally sustainable disposal methods such as composting and incineration.

On the other hand, sanitation challenges in public markets are not limited to waste disposal alone. Inadequate sanitation infrastructure also plays a significant role. Kosoko and Hassan (2021) reported that many markets in developing countries lack sufficient toilet facilities, resulting in poor environmental sanitation. Likewise, Pitriyanti and Kartika (2024) found that limited access to sanitation facilities contributes to the spread of sanitation-related diseases. Their study also revealed that many markets do not fully comply with clean and healthy living standards, increasing health risks among vendors and consumers.

Lastly, similar sanitation issues have been observed in other regions. Meki et al. (2021) examined market sanitation conditions in Lusaka District, Zambia, and found that many markets were in poor condition and failed to comply with sanitation regulations. The study emphasized that markets with inadequate sanitation are more prone to public health problems due to crowding and the sale of easily contaminated food products. These findings highlight the need for improved sanitation management, adequate infrastructure, and stronger enforcement of health regulations in public markets.

Security and Safety

Although public markets face numerous operational challenges, the implementation of safety and security measures has shown positive effects on both stallholders and customers. The revision and enforcement of market codes, such as the Omnibus Market Code of Tarlac City in 2020, have contributed to improved governance and clearer operational rules, which enhance order and safety within the market (Tomas, 2022). Moreover, these regulations often include provisions related to hygiene and sanitation, which are essential in preventing health hazards. When such standards are properly implemented, the market environment becomes safer and more organized, leading to increased satisfaction among stall owners and consumers (Alvarez et al., 2024).

In addition, public administrations play a significant role in strengthening safety in open municipal markets through the establishment and enforcement of safety standards (Fava et al., 2022). Market renovation initiatives further support economic growth and community development by providing safer and more organized trading environments, as demonstrated in the case of the Ibaan Public Market (Almonte et al., 2024). Furthermore, improvements in infrastructure often include enhanced security features and better waste management systems. Proper handling and disposal of waste help maintain cleanliness and safety, thereby reducing the risk of accidents and hazards within the market premises (Sayson et al., 2025).

However, despite ongoing efforts to improve security and safety, many public markets—particularly traditional and informal ones—continue to experience significant challenges. One common issue is the lack of adequate sanitary facilities, as observed in public markets in Lusaka District, Zambia (Meki et al., 2021). This situation raises serious concerns regarding hygiene, sanitation, and the increased risk of foodborne illnesses and other health-related problems (Dewaal et al., 2025). Similarly, Putro et al. (2024) noted that poor market management, especially in traditional vegetable markets, has resulted in vendor dissatisfaction, reduced income, and decreased investment in market stalls. Moreover, studies conducted in Benin City, Nigeria, reveal that neglected environmental conditions contribute to unsafe and insecure trading environments, negatively affecting stallholder operations and potentially leading to economic losses (Imarhiagbe & Eghomwanre, 2023).

Furthermore, inconsistent enforcement of market rules significantly increases security vulnerabilities among stallholders. Regulations concerning curfew hours and the deployment of security personnel are often weakly implemented, limiting their effectiveness. For example, although the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit provides legal protection against theft and other illicit activities, inconsistent implementation reduces its overall impact (Nasipit

Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020). Lastly, studies on traditional market revitalization consistently emphasize the need for improved security systems, better infrastructure, and effective surveillance mechanisms. Despite their importance, these measures are frequently insufficient or absent, leaving stallholders exposed to various security risks (Davies et al., 2022).

Service Areas / Facilities

Adequate storage facilities are essential in maintaining the quality and safety of goods sold in public markets. Dewaal and Trevenen-Jones (2025) emphasized that proper storage helps prevent spoilage and contamination, thereby protecting both consumer health and product value. Moreover, auxiliary facilities such as sanitation and waste management systems play a critical role in ensuring cleanliness and hygiene within the market environment. Studies conducted in Sub-Saharan Africa have shown that effective storage practices significantly reduce losses caused by spoilage, contamination, and wastage, leading to improved public health outcomes and economic sustainability (Aworh, 2021). Similarly, perishable products such as meat and fish require cold storage facilities to remain fresh and safe for consumption (Basadre et al., 2025). In response, some markets have invested in refrigeration systems, enabling vendors to extend product shelf life, reduce food loss, and increase profitability.

Furthermore, access to basic utilities and supporting facilities is vital in maintaining a healthy and efficient market environment. The availability of clean water, functional toilet facilities, and reliable garbage disposal systems contributes to improved sanitation for both vendors and customers. Access to potable water allows vendors to clean their produce and maintain hygienic stalls, thereby reducing the risk of product contamination. In addition, the physical design of market spaces influences both safety and customer experience. Well-planned market alleys facilitate smooth movement and reduce congestion, enhancing the overall market experience (Rosales et al., 2023).

Moreover, appropriate spatial organization within markets improves accessibility and safety. Remolino et al. (2023) noted that sufficient spacing between kiosks helps prevent overcrowding, while clean and dry aisles provide safer and more comfortable access for customers. Additionally, proper market structuring ensures that commodities are well displayed and easily visible to buyers, increasing the likelihood of purchase. Such thoughtful planning enhances market attractiveness, which can lead to improved sales performance and stronger customer loyalty (Dudziak et al., 2023).

However, despite the recognized benefits of adequate infrastructure and facilities, many public markets continue to face substantial challenges. Onuegbu (2024) reported that the Eke Okigwe Market in Nigeria suffers from inadequate infrastructure, poor storage facilities, and inefficient waste collection systems. These shortcomings limit the market's ability to ensure product safety and operational efficiency.

In addition, similar infrastructure deficiencies have been observed in other contexts. Pitriyanti and Kartika (2024) found that building structures and sanitation facilities in the Sedanau Island Traditional Market in Indonesia failed to meet required standards. Likewise, Atilano-Tang and Laudin (2023) identified challenges in policy implementation in Zamboanga City, particularly due to limited resources for enforcement and compliance monitoring.

Ultimately, studies conducted in peri-urban areas of Africa further highlight persistent infrastructure challenges in low- and middle-income countries. Wallace et al. (2022) reported that many markets lack permanent access to clean potable water, toilet facilities, electricity, and cold storage. Additional constraints include limited space, inadequate waste disposal facilities, insufficient investment in waste management, poor processing facilities, and substandard road access. Similarly, markets in Lusaka District, Zambia, were found to be in poor condition and non-compliant with sanitation regulations, with deficiencies in toilets, handwashing stations, and

service areas, as well as poor maintenance and lack of privacy (Meki et al., 2021).

Award and Occupancy of Stalls

The Revised Market Code of Nasipit ensures the principle of equity and community participation in the assignment of stalls. According to Section 28, only assigned vendors shall occupy the stalls, which shall be reserved for residents, and then by the class of merchandise carried by the organization. Section 26 then created a Market Committee that shall operate and address the Market's problems. Section 4 prohibits stallholders from occupying stalls or spaces other than their respective leased stalls. Further, Section 28 states that the Awardees of Market Stalls shall pay a One-time "Goodwill Fee" equivalent to Php. $10,000.00 and a deposit of two months' advance rental, which is a burden on the vendors' own poor capitalization. (Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020).

Alvarez and Mananap (2024) investigated the satisfaction of stall owners regarding public market operations. They found that efficient management of stall occupancy contributed to vendor satisfaction. Similarly, Lano et al. (2025) investigated customer preferences and the level of competitiveness among vendors in public markets in Calapan City, implicitly addressing how stall placement and occupancy affect the success of the businesses and the satisfaction of the vendors. Similarly, Putro et al. (2024) conducted research on the determinants of vendor satisfaction in a traditional vegetable market, which often includes components related to stall assignment and the management system. This finding is consistent with the results of a study conducted in Northern Mindanao, Philippines, which emphasized the importance of strengthening partnerships for marketing and consolidating organic products by providing dedicated market spaces for these products in public markets (Paurom et al., 2025). Similarly, Hasbullah & Wangi (2021) found that there should be a policy or regulation to simplify and expedite the investment procedure. Additionally, Tomas (2022) found in his study that the

implementation of market stall awards in Tarlac City involves city officials presenting certificates to the winners after bidding and payment, followed by the signing of contracts and the submission of security deposits to secure possession of stalls. The results of this study show that awarding is highly implemented, with business permit renewals regularly monitored by the market authorities themselves.

In the case of the Lusari Kidul Modern Market in Cirebon Regency, however, it was mentioned that management over market stalls could sometimes be conflictual, particularly in instances where established regulations are lacking or not consistently applied to address the resolution of conflicts of interest in market arrangement, specifically in regulating modern Market stalls (Maulana et. al. 2025). Moreover, a study by Adhayanto and Arianto (2021) on adjusting rental rates for market stalls and kiosks in Pt. The Tanjungpinang Makmur Bersama Market in Indonesia further illustrates the economic considerations associated with stall occupancy, which have a direct impact on vendors and market sustainability.

Ultimately, the abandonment of the Malimgas Public Market project in Dagupan City highlights weaknesses in contractor accountability and the monitoring of public projects. The contractor, after it stopped working, declared bankruptcy and left the vendors with unfinished and unsafe facilities in the middle. This raises questions about the misuse of public funds and calls for tighter monitoring to ensure that contractors fulfill their commitments accordingly (GMA News, 2025).

Rules of Conduct

Effective discipline and consistent enforcement have been shown to significantly reduce non-compliance in public markets. Pratama and Tukiman (2024) reported that strict enforcement measures in Keputran Market, Surabaya, resulted in a notable reduction in illegal vending activities. Their study emphasized that while strong disciplinary actions are necessary, continuous

supervision by local authorities remains essential. Similarly, Ni'am et al. (2024) stressed that adequate monitoring and enforcement are critical in ensuring vendor compliance, as excessive leniency often leads to disorder and unsanitary conditions in public market environments.

Moreover, empirical evidence from the Philippines demonstrates that regulatory effectiveness is strengthened when clear rules are paired with appropriate penalties. An ordinance prohibiting the use of Styrofoam and single-use plastics in Cabugao Public Market achieved higher compliance due to the proper establishment of regulations and enforcement mechanisms (Baptista et al., 2024). Likewise, in Baguio City, policies restricting the use of plastic and Styrofoam were effective only when supported by regular monitoring and sustained awareness campaigns among vendors (Killip & Dadulla, 2023). These cases highlight the importance of enforcement and education in promoting environmental sustainability in public markets.

Furthermore, local ordinances provide structured operational guidelines aimed at maintaining cleanliness, safety, and order within public markets. Section 5 of the Revised Market Code of Nasipit mandates that public markets be maintained in a clean and sanitary condition to protect the health and safety of vendors, consumers, and market personnel. In addition, Section 19 specifies operational hours from 3:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m., reinforcing order and sanitation standards. The ordinance also restricts peddling on sidewalks and public passageways and prohibits the use of market stalls as living quarters, with penalties including permit cancellation. Moreover, Section 28 requires vendors to secure the necessary licenses before operating a market stall, underscoring the importance of regulatory compliance (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020).

However, despite the existence of regulatory frameworks, many low- and middle-income cities continue to face challenges in market governance. Wallace et al. (2024) noted that

inadequate waste collection and transportation systems contribute to the accumulation of solid waste in public markets. Additionally, the reliance on non-centralized open-air waste treatment limits the effectiveness of disposal methods such as incineration, thereby reducing overall waste management efficiency.

Consequently, poor market management often leads to vendor dissatisfaction and non-compliance. Putro et al. (2024) observed that when vendors perceive market authorities as unresponsive to their concerns, their willingness to comply with regulations decreases. Wibisono et al. (2023) further noted that unfair or unclear taxation systems can generate resentment among vendors. Moreover, insufficient market revenue limits investments in essential infrastructure such as sanitation and waste disposal systems, which further hinders compliance with hygiene standards (Onwonga, 2024).

Market fees & Electrical Charges/Fees

A study in Nairobi City County, Kenya, identified various revenue sources—including taxes, fees, licenses, and user charges—that contribute to the financial sustainability of urban markets. Analysis revealed diverse revenue types, including direct payments from market traders and indirect contributions from market-related activities such as advertising and rentals. Market fees are a crucial source of revenue for local governments, enabling them to improve urban service delivery. Furthermore, findings indicated substantial revenue generated from urban markets, underscoring their economic significance and potential for financing market operations, infrastructure development, and service provision. This emphasizes the importance of optimizing revenue collection mechanisms, promoting transparency, and allocating resources efficiently to maximize the benefits derived from market-generated revenues (Owonga, 2024).

In addition, Ninsiima et al. (2025) mentioned that revenue can be reinvested in market maintenance, infrastructure development, and sanitation services, enhancing the overall market

environment. Adhayanto et al. (2023) also highlight that market fees play a key role in boosting local government revenue through profits from regionally owned enterprises. Decentralization and regional autonomy policies have enabled governments to expand their revenue sources via locally generated income (PAD), with one significant source being dividends from regionally owned enterprises (BUMD).

Similarly, the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit outlines specific fees, such as rental fees for stalls, booths, and spaces, to ensure income generation for market operations. Section 44 states that the Municipal Treasurer or authorized collectors shall handle the collection of all local taxes, fees, and charges, showing a structured financial system. Moreover, Section 49 provides that stall lessees who consume electricity within the Nasipit Public Market shall pay additional charges to cover utility costs. Section 28 grants preference to resident applicants for stall leases and gives priority to those who pay the goodwill money first, which may result in inequities based on financial capacity. Section 51 imposes a 2 percent surcharge on unpaid bills from the preceding month and authorizes the disconnection of electricity supply if arrearages remain unpaid after two months, ensuring compliance with payment regulations (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020).

On the other hand, high or unfairly applied market fees can pose a significant financial burden on vendors, particularly small-scale traders. This can reduce their profitability and discourage them from operating in the market, leading to decreased economic activity. High electrical charges can also create a financial strain on vendors, especially those with limited resources (Adhayanto & Arianto, 2021). Finally, Wibisono et al. (2023) note that the collection of market fees can be susceptible to corruption and mismanagement, diverting funds away from intended improvements.

Restrictions

The Revised Market Code of Nasipit, Article B, provides several rules to ensure order, cleanliness, and safety within the public market. Section 36 states that peddling and hawking in passageways, aisles, and sidewalks is strictly prohibited, and meat or fish cannot be sold outside the market area before 7:00 p.m. Section 37 also prohibits the consumption or sale of alcohol inside the market, which can lead to the loss of a stall lease. Furthermore, Section 38 requires roaming animals to be claimed within 24 hours for a fee, while Section 39 subjects' parents to fines if children are found loitering or playing in the market. Finally, Section 40 requires approval for any construction, and Section 41 prevents ejected stallholders from applying for a new lease (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020).

Tomas (2022) points out that peddlers and hawkers who travel from place to place to sell small amounts of goods are increasing in number and causing market passageways to become crowded. Even though the pandemic led to more informal vendors, the study shows that market laws are often "Sometimes Implemented" rather than strictly followed. For example, penalties for abandoning stalls or using broken weighing scales are not consistently enforced. The study also found that rules against drinking alcohol are inconsistent because the problem still exists. However, authorities are more active in stopping sidewalk vending, which is "Often Implemented," showing that they focus more on certain issues than others.

Moreover, Ghali-Mohammed et al. (2024) suggest that the best way to manage informal food sellers is through government licensing and training programs. They explain that local enforcement can be made stronger by letting community health workers and market groups monitor and report unsafe food handling. By doing this, markets can better protect the public from food-borne diseases and make sure that items like fish are safe to eat. This approach helps keep the market environment healthy and ensures that food safety standards are maintained for

everyone.

Prohibition

According to Cataluna & Rukmini (2024), enforcing prohibitions on unhygienic practices among vendors is essential for protecting public health. Their systematic review found that knowledge and practice of hygiene and sanitation remain insufficient among vendors. They emphasize that regulations banning contamination-prone practices must be coupled with regular inspections, training, and support to ensure compliance. Likewise, studies of plastic-waste prohibition measures indicate that banning certain single-use plastics or restricting their distribution can significantly reduce environmental pollution (Atilano-Tang & Laudin, 2023).

In the Philippines, Baptista et al. (2024) examined the ordinance prohibiting the use of Styrofoam and single- use plastics in Cabugao Public Market. They found that compliance increased when clear rules and penalties were implemented. This supports the idea that well-communicated restrictions and local enforcement help maintain environmental cleanliness and market sustainability. Similarly, in Baguio City, prohibitory policies on plastic and Styrofoam use were effective only when combined with regular monitoring and vendor awareness programs (Killip & Dadulla, 2023).

In contrast, a study by Mensah et al. (2022) found limited public compliance with sanitation and environmental prohibitions in Ghana, despite the existence of such bans. In their findings, regulation falls significantly short of actual practice. One would need appropriate enforcement mechanisms, supported by public education and awareness, to actually attain the desired results of these kinds of prohibitions. Similarly, Araune et al. (2024) observed that sanitation prohibitions were not strictly implemented in a Barangay community in Northern Mindanao. The simple fact that there are rules does not mean that people will necessarily comply with the standards of sanitation. Similarly, the enforcement of an ordinance prohibiting the use

of Styrofoam containers and regulating single-use plastics in the Cabugao Public Market revealed that although awareness was high, there were still some setbacks regarding its enforcement and compliance (Baptista et al., 2024). Additionally, Killip et al. (2023) assessed the implementation of a plastic and Styrofoam-free policy in the Baguio City Public Market. They identified several obstacles to effective enforcement, despite the presence of explicit prohibitions.

General Provision and Control

According to Edmonds & Carsjens (2021), well-defined general provisions in the municipal codes are crucial for encouraging order and coherence within a market environment. This study of markets in Michigan cities underscores the importance of clear regulatory frameworks in ensuring the orderly operation and effective management of public markets. This, as identified by Fava et al. (2022), highlights the propitious Role of supportive policies and governance mechanisms that public administrations can implement for open municipal markets. In Kabale and Mbarara Central Markets, efforts were made to explore avenues for stakeholder involvement in the management of public markets in urban centers (Ninsiima et al., 2025).

In contrast to these, traditional Market and rural–urban food system governance in sub-Saharan Africa is especially burdened by weakness in the existing institutional and regulatory frameworks. These weaknesses hamper efficient market functioning and regulation, therefore providing a better understanding of issues related to the management of traditional markets and their impact on local food systems. In a related study, Onwonga (2024) discusses the Role of the county's own- source revenue in the provision and management of markets within Nairobi City County. He underscores the relationship between fiscal sustainability and market governance.

In addition, Tomas (2022) examined the 2020 Omnibus Market Code of Tarlac City and found a gap between policy and practice. While the Code is comprehensive, inconsistent enforcement means its regulations are not always effective in real-world market operations.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study will be anchored in the Policy Implementation Theory developed by George C. Edwards III in 1980. The theory provides a foundational framework for analyzing the processes and factors that influence the successful implementation of public policies. Edwards identified that effectiveness in policy implementation is a result of the interaction of four critical variables: communication, resources, the disposition of the implementers, and the bureaucratic structure. These elements shape how policies are interpreted, supported, acted upon, and institutionalized. For this research, the theory of Policy Implementation provides the explanations for the degree of adherence to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit. Communication is how the substance of the market code is clearly and consistently conveyed to stakeholders, including vendors, consumers, and local authorities. Resources are defined to include all economic, human, and material inputs needed to carry out the market code effectively. Disposition refers to the attitudes, motivation, and willingness of implementers, or local market authorities, to implement the policy. Bureaucratic structure refers to the organizational systems, processes, and coordination mechanisms in the municipal government to support and sustain enforcement and monitoring activities (Edwards, 1980).

Support for the applicability of Edwards's theory within this research can be seen from several studies, such as Pratama and Tukiman (2024), who applied Edwards's model when examining the enforcement of regulations for street vendors in Keputran Market, Surabaya. The results demonstrated a furtherance in regulatory understanding and compliance due to good communication between local government leaders and the community. Adequate staffing and support for logistics ensured a smooth implementation, within well-defined standard operating procedures that provided bureaucratic stability. However, variable motivation among implementers led to differences in enforcement levels. The finding showed that disposition is a

crucial variable to be considered for policy impact. By adopting Edwards's Policy Implementation Theory, the present study assesses compliance with the Revised Market Code as an outcome of the effectiveness with which the four interdependent factors operate in the local setting. Where communication is clear, resources are sufficient, implementers are committed, and the bureaucratic structure is functioning well, higher levels of compliance among the market actors are expected. Conversely, defects in any of them may create obstacles to implementation and result in lower levels of compliance. Hence, this theoretical framework not only justifies the research problem but also orients the investigation of the link between policy intentions and actual practices in the context of the Nasipit Public Market.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

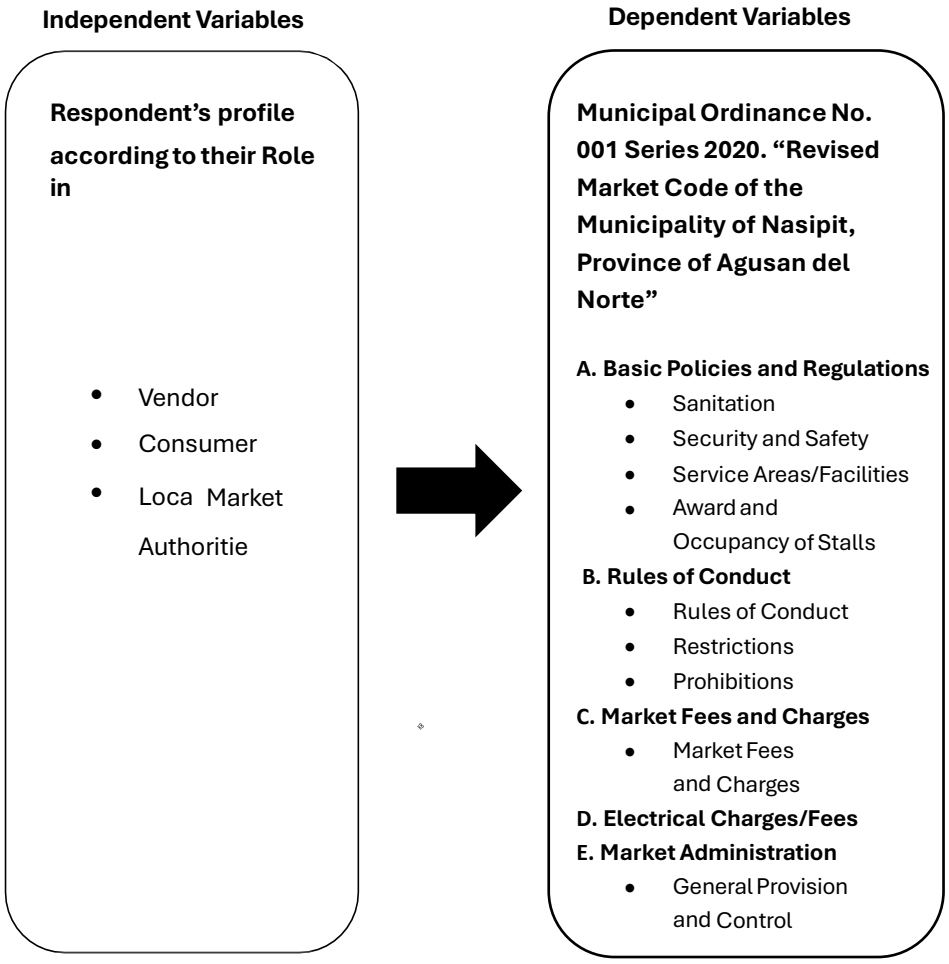


Figure 1. The schematic diagram shows the interplay of the independent and dependent variables of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study will evaluate compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit. Specifically, this study will answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the Respondents according to their Role in the Market:
    - 1.1 vendors,
    - 1.2 consumers; and
    - 1.3 local market authorities.
2. What is the level of compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit according to the general provisions:
    - 2.1 **Basic Policies and Regulations**
        - 2.1.1 sanitation,
        - 2.1.2 security and safety,
        - 2.1.3 service areas/facilities; and
        - 2.1.4 award and occupancy of stalls.
    - 2.2 **Restrictions and Rules of Conduct**
        - 2.2.1 rules of conduct,
        - 2.2.2 restrictions, and
        - 2.2.3 prohibitions.
    - 2.3 **Market Fees and Charges**
        - 2.3.1 market fees and charges.
    - 2.4 **Electrical Charges/Fees**
    - 2.5 **Market Administration**
        - 2.5.1 general provision and control; and
        - 2.5.2 market personnel.

3. Is there a significant difference between the level of compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit when respondents are grouped according to their role in the market: vendors, consumers, and local market authorities?

1.6 Hypothesis

The Hypothesis will guide the study and test at a = 0.05 level of significance.

There is no significant difference between the level of compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit when respondents are grouped according to their Role in the Market: vendors, consumers, and local market authorities.

Scope and Limitation of the Study

This study will focus on assessing the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, with particular attention to the general provisions governing basic policies and regulations, restrictions and rules of conduct, market charges/fees, and market administration. The assessment will involve three main groups of respondents, including vendors, consumers, and local market authorities.

The scope of this study will focus on the practical application and adherence to the Revised Market Code within the specific area of public market operations in the Municipality of Nasipit. It will not delve into detailed legal interpretations of the Code itself, nor will it compare Nasipit's market code with those of other municipalities.

1.7 Definition of Terms

To provide clarity, the following terms are defined conceptually and operationally:

Assessment – refers to the systematic process of gathering, analyzing, and interpreting information to determine the level of compliance and effectiveness of implementing the revised market code in the municipality of Nasipit.

Award and Occupancy of Stalls – the process of assigning and regulating the use of market stalls to vendors in the Nasipit Public Market, based on criteria, procedures, and duration outlined in the revised market code.

Compliance – the degree to which market stakeholders, such as vendors, market administrators, and consumers, adhere to the regulations and provisions stated in the revised market code.

Consumers – individuals who visit the Nasipit Public Market to purchase goods and are expected to observe proper conduct and cleanliness within the market premises.

General Provision and Control – the overall rules, authority, and administrative mechanisms established by the municipality to govern, supervise, and regulate operations in the Nasipit Public Market, ensuring adherence to the revised market code.

Market fees – mandatory financial contributions, including stall rents and service fees, collected from vendors in the Nasipit public Market as provided under the revised market code, used for market maintenance and municipal revenue.

Market Personnel – authorized staff and employees responsible for managing, supervising, and maintaining the Nasipit public Market, including security, administrative, and maintenance personnel, as designated in the revised market code.

Municipality of Nasipit – a first-class municipality located in the province of Agusan del Norte, Philippines, which serves as the local government unit (LGU) responsible for the enforcement of the revised market code.

Prohibitions – explicitly forbidden actions, such as unauthorized vending, unsafe practices, or violation of ordinances, within the Nasipit public Market, as mandated by the revised market code.
Revised Market Code – the updated version of the municipal ordinance no. 001 series 2020, which outlines the policies, standards, and procedures for proper market administration and operations within the municipality of Nasipit.

Restrictions – specific limitations imposed on activities, products, or services in the nasipit public Market to ensure compliance with the revised market code, protect public welfare, and maintain market order.

Rules of Conduct – prescribed behaviors and standards expected from vendors, consumers, and local market authorities within the Nasipit public Market, as defined by the revised market code, to maintain order, discipline, and professionalism.

Sanitation – the maintenance of hygienic conditions in the Market, including waste management, drainage, cleaning, and disposal practices, as required under the revised market code.

Security and safety – refer to the implementation of safety protocols, surveillance, and emergency measures within the Nasipit Public Market to protect vendors, consumers, and local Market authorities, in accordance with the revised market code.

Service Areas/Facilities – designated functional spaces within the Nasipit Public Market, including washrooms, storage areas, and loading zones, maintained to provide convenience and support for market operations as stipulated in the revised market code

Vendors – individuals or business operators who occupy stalls or spaces in the Nasipit Public Market to sell goods and are subject to compliance with the provisions of the revised market Code.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter presented the Research Design, Research Materials and Methods, Research Environment, Population and Sample, Research Data and Analysis Plan, and Research Ethical Standards.

2.1 Research Design

This study will employ a quantitative-descriptive approach to examine the compliance level of the Revised Market Code in the Municipality of Nasipit. The quantitative approach is appropriate in this instance because the study will utilize a structured market survey questionnaire designed to capture measurable data on compliance among vendors, consumers, and local market authorities. In contrast, a descriptive design suits the study, given that it aims to examine compliance and describe that compliance without altering any variables

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

This study will utilize a self-made questionnaire anchored in Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020, the "Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, Province of Agusan del Norte". The instrument will undergo pilot testing and be validated by experts in the field to ensure its reliability and appropriateness for data collection. The survey questionnaire will consist of two (2) parts:

Part I: Respondent Profile. This section will gather information about the respondent's profile according to their Role in the Market.

Part II: Compliance Assessment. This section will assess the respondents' compliance with the Municipal Market No. 001 Series 2020, the "Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, Province of Agusan del Norte", consisting of basic policies and regulations, restrictions, rules of conduct, market fees, electrical fees/charges, market administration, and general penal provision.

Table 2. shows the scale description of the survey questionnaire of the study.

Scale	Verbal Description	Interpretation
4	**Always Compliant (AC)**	The respondent consistently follows the provision with no lapses. Compliance is practiced at all times.
3	**Often Compliant (OC)**	The respondent follows the provision most of the time, but with only minor or occasional lapses provision
2	**Sometimes Compliant (SC)**	The respondent follows the provision occasionally, but overall compliance is low.
1	**Never Compliant (NC)**	The respondent does not follow the provision at all, non-compliance is consistent.

The instrument will use a Likert scale format to measure the degree of agreement with each statement. This table guides the interpretation of Likert scale results in assessing the level of compliance to the revised market code of the municipality of Nasipit. It will use a 4-point rating scale, where a score of 4 "Always Compliant, a score of 3 "Often Compliant", a score of 2 "Sometimes Compliant", and a score of 1 "Never Compliant". This scale will be used to evaluate the strength of respondents' level of compliance to the revised market code's provision.

Also, the instrument will be translated into the local dialect (Cebuano/Bisaya) and will undergo back-translation to ensure that all respondents can easily understand and accurately respond to the survey.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

Research Environment

This study will be conducted in the Municipality of Nasipit, located in the province of Agusan del Norte, Caraga, Mindanao, Philippines. Nasipit is a third-class municipality, known as the gateway to Agusan del Norte, due to its international seaport, the Nasipit Port. Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, was established as a declared pueblo by Spanish colonizers in the 1880s, marking its formal foundation. The municipality's name, "Nasipit," is said to have originated from a

misunderstanding about a crab bite, giving it a unique local identity. Officially separating from Butuan on August 1, 1929, Nasipit became a distinct municipality, thereby cementing its place in Agusan del Norte's history, and even resisting a proposed name change to Aurora.

The municipality of Nasipit in Agusan del Norte has a population of 44,929 people and composed of 19 barangays, each contributing to its economic, social, and cultural activities. A central feature of Nasipit's economy will be its public Market, which will serve as the hub of commerce and trade for residents, nearby communities, and travelers.

Research Respondents

The respondents of this study will consist of vendors, consumers, and local market authorities operating in the Public Market of the Municipality of Nasipit. The consumers will specifically refer to regular market patrons who frequently purchase goods at the Nasipit Public Market.

A purposive sampling technique will be used to select vendors and local market authorities, while convenience sampling will be applied to the consumers.

Table 1. Respondents of the Study.

Role in the Market	Population Size	Sample (n)	Percentage (%)
Vendor	192	100	52.32
Consumer	150	61	40.87
Local Market Authorities	25	2	6.81
Total	367	163	100

Table 1 shows the distribution of respondents in the study.

A total of (52.32%) samples from a total population of (192) among the vendors in the Nasipit Public Market. A total of (40.87%) from a total of (150) is derived from the consumers of the Nasipit Public Market. Lastly, a total of (6.81%) from a total population of (25) is derived from

the local market authorities of the Nasipit Public Market.

Research Population

The research population of this study will consist of all identified stakeholders operating within the Nasipit Public Market in the Municipality of Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. Specifically, the population will include **192** registered vendors, **150** regular consumers (market patrons) and **25** local market authorities.

This will result in a total population of **367** respondents. These groups will be included because they are directly involved in the implementation, observance, and enforcement of the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit.

Research Sample

From the total population of 367 respondents, a sample of **163** participants will be selected for the study. The distribution of the sample will be as follows: **100** vendors out of 192, **61** consumers out of 150 and **2** local market authorities out of 25

A purposive sampling technique will be used to select vendors and local market authorities to ensure that respondents are directly involved in market operations and enforcement of the Revised Market Code. Meanwhile, a convenience sampling technique will be applied in selecting consumers, particularly regular market patrons who will be available and willing to participate during the data collection period.

For consumers, only respondents aged 18 to 60 years old will be included in the study to ensure valid and ethical participation.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Data Gathering Procedure

With the Mayor's approval, the researchers will request permission from the Office of the Mayor of Nasipit to obtain the number of vendors and local market authorities at the Nasipit

Public Market. Researchers will distribute survey forms after obtaining respondents' consent and will allow sufficient time for them to complete the forms. After completing the questionnaires, the researchers will collect and examine them, then calculate the mean of the results to summarize the findings on conformity with the Revised Market Code.

Letter of Approval: The researchers will submit a letter of request to the Office of the Mayor of Nasipit to validate the study and obtain permission to proceed with assessing compliance with the revised market code. Orientation: The researchers will conduct an orientation for the respondents to inform them about the study and ensure they understand the ethical agreements related to assessing compliance with the revised market code.

Distribution of Informed Consent Forms: The researchers will distribute informed consent forms to the respondents, which will serve as agreements confirming that they understand their rights and have the freedom to agree or decline to participate in the study, in compliance with the revised market code.

Distribution of Questionnaire: The researchers will personally distribute the survey questionnaires to the respondents. The researchers will give respondents ample time to provide the information required for the study on compliance with the revised market code.

Retrieval of the Questionnaire and Consent Form: After the allotted time, the researchers will personally retrieve the completed questionnaires and consent forms to prepare for data collection related to assessing compliance with the revised market code. Gathering of Data: The data will be collected, checked for completeness, tallied, presented, analyzed, and interpreted using appropriate statistical techniques and tools to assess the level of compliance with the revised market code.

Statistical Treatment

The following statistical techniques and methods were employed to facilitate the presentation, analysis, and interpretation of the findings.

The researchers will use **frequency and percentage** to determine the distribution and rate of the total number of respondents.

Researchers will use the **weighted mean** to assess the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit.

The **One-Way ANOVA** will be used to determine the significant difference in the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit among respondents grouped by their Role in the Market: vendors, consumers, and local market authorities.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This research will not involve the development of new technologies, processes, or products that require patent protection. However, the study will include original elements, such as the questionnaires, which will be copyrighted to safeguard the study's distinctive contribution. Furthermore, there will be no distinct brand, logo, or symbol associated with this research. Thus, trademark protection will not be necessary.

B. Informed Consent

Respondents will be selected using purposive and convenience sampling based on availability, willingness to participate, and involvement in the Nasipit Public Market. Only vendors, consumers, and local market authorities aged 18 to 60 years will be included, while individuals below the legal age will be excluded to ensure ethical compliance and valid informed consent.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The researchers will maintain and protect the confidentiality of the respondents in this study in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 and other applicable data protection regulations. No personal or sensitive information will be disclosed, and all responses will be anonymized through the use of codes instead of names. The research findings will not be linked or directly attributed to any specific respondent or participating institution. All gathered data will be stored securely in password-protected digital files and locked storage for printed documents, accessible only to the researchers.

Upon completion of the study and after the required retention period of one (1) year, all collected data will be permanently and securely disposed of. Digital files will be deleted using secure data-erasure methods, and physical documents will be shredded to prevent reconstruction. Any identifiers linking respondents to their data will be destroyed immediately after data analysis is completed. This ensures that no traceable personal information remains once the research objectives have been fulfilled.

D. Voluntary Participation

In this study, the respondents will be volunteers. The selected vendors, consumers, and local market authorities will not be obligated to continue the survey if the respondents believe it causes emotional or physical harm. Also, the researchers will ensure that they will have no personal or professional connections with the selected respondents that could influence the objectivity of the study, and no form of monetary remuneration, material incentives, or financial compensation will be provided to the respondents in exchange for their participation. Selection will be conducted fairly and transparently to ensure that the findings remain unbiased and credible.

E. Minimization of Harm

The researchers will conduct face-to-face surveys with vendors, consumers, and authorities at the Nasipit Public Market using printed questionnaires. Participation is entirely voluntary and will take place on-site at a time that suits the respondents. To minimize work disruption, the surveys will be administered during quiet hours. Because the study takes place in a familiar public environment, no harm to participants is anticipated, and they may opt out of the study at any point.

F. Beneficence

The research purpose is to positively impact the local government by providing insights into the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit. The findings will help the Local Market Authorities of Nasipit identify areas for improvement in policy enforcement and market management. After all the research findings are completed, all rndents will be given access upon request.

G. Justice and Fair Respondents Selection

The researchers will select respondents fairly and transparently, ensuring that market vendors, consumers, and local authorities from different backgrounds (e.g. race, religion, gender, ethnicity) and sectors are equally represented. This will promote fairness and inclusivity, ensuring that all relevant groups are represented in assessing compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researchers will use clear and organized methods to ensure accurate and consistent data collection and analysis. To maintain objectivity, access to the data will be limited to the researchers. The researchers will also consider potential biases and limitations that could affect the results, such as sampling issues or unclear responses. When some respondents leave parts of

the survey unanswered, the researchers will respectfully follow up and ask to complete the missing items to ensure the data is valid and complete. To address these concerns, specialists will authenticate the survey, incomplete forms will be adequately managed, and all findings will be provided honestly.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The study findings will be reported truthfully, with all sources properly cited, and there will be no manipulation of data. Both positive and negative results will be presented to ensure an honest and transparent representation of the findings. To uphold research integrity, peer debriefing sessions will be conducted with fellow researchers and academic mentors throughout the study. These sessions will ensure that interpretations of the data will be unbiased and will align with the research objectives. Additionally, all stages of data analysis and decision-making will be documented, allowing for future verification and audit. This process will strengthen accountability and will ensure that conclusions will be based solely on factual evidence and sound analytical procedures.

J. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researchers will use clear and organized methods to ensure accurate and consistent data collection and analysis. To maintain objectivity, access to the data will be limited to the researchers. The researchers will also consider potential biases and limitations that could affect the results, such as sampling issues or unclear responses. When some respondents leave parts of the survey unanswered, the researchers will respectfully follow up and ask to complete the missing items to ensure the data is valid and complete. To address these concerns, specialists will authenticate the survey, incomplete forms will be adequately managed, and all findings will be provided honestly. These steps will help keep ethical standards high and make the study more credible.

K. Transparency in Reporting

The results of this study will be disclosed with utmost honesty and transparency, guaranteeing that the collected data will not be excluded, misconstrued, or modified. All contents that have been published before and are still under copyright will be appropriately cited and credited. AI tools will be utilized to enhance and refine information relevant to specific aspects of the ongoing research. The researchers will declare that the study is free from any financial, personal, or professional conflicts of interest.

L. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The study will not utilize any patented materials; therefore, no approval from patent owners is required. The researchers will cite all copyrighted materials, including relevant literature, and obtain necessary permissions.

M. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

Ethical considerations in research necessitate a thorough understanding of the study's potential effects, benefits, and risks. The researchers will inform respondents that this study poses no physical risks, as it focuses solely on their responses and does not involve any physical activities. However, the researchers will provide proper support services if necessary. Since no animals will be involved, ethical clearance for animal use will not be required. The focus will be solely on human respondents, with sufficient ethical frameworks and procedures to ensure their safety and obtain informed consent.

N. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

The researchers will utilize AI tools such as Grammarly and Quillbot to enhance the study's grammar and clarity. ChatGPT will also assist with the writing process and help you select the most suitable words. These tools will only be used to assist the researchers, not to replace their own thoughts and decisions. The researchers will carefully review and evaluate all the ideas, analyses,

and findings. They will ensure that the study remains accurate, trustworthy, and ethical by employing AI appropriately and verifying all its outputs.

O. Ethical Approval

This research will receive ethical approval from the Research Ethics Committee (REC) of Saint Michael College of Caraga, which confirms that it adheres to all relevant guidelines on the protection of respondents, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

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CHAPTER 3

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data

3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Out

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CHAPTER 4

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, RECOMMENDAT

4.1. Summary

4.2. Conclusion

4.3.Recommendation

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APPENDICES

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP